

PARISHRAM 2027

**MY MOTHER AT^y
SIXTY SIX**

LECTURE : 03

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Topics to be Covered

1 Game

2 Flamingo:
My Mother At Sixty Six

3 Questions

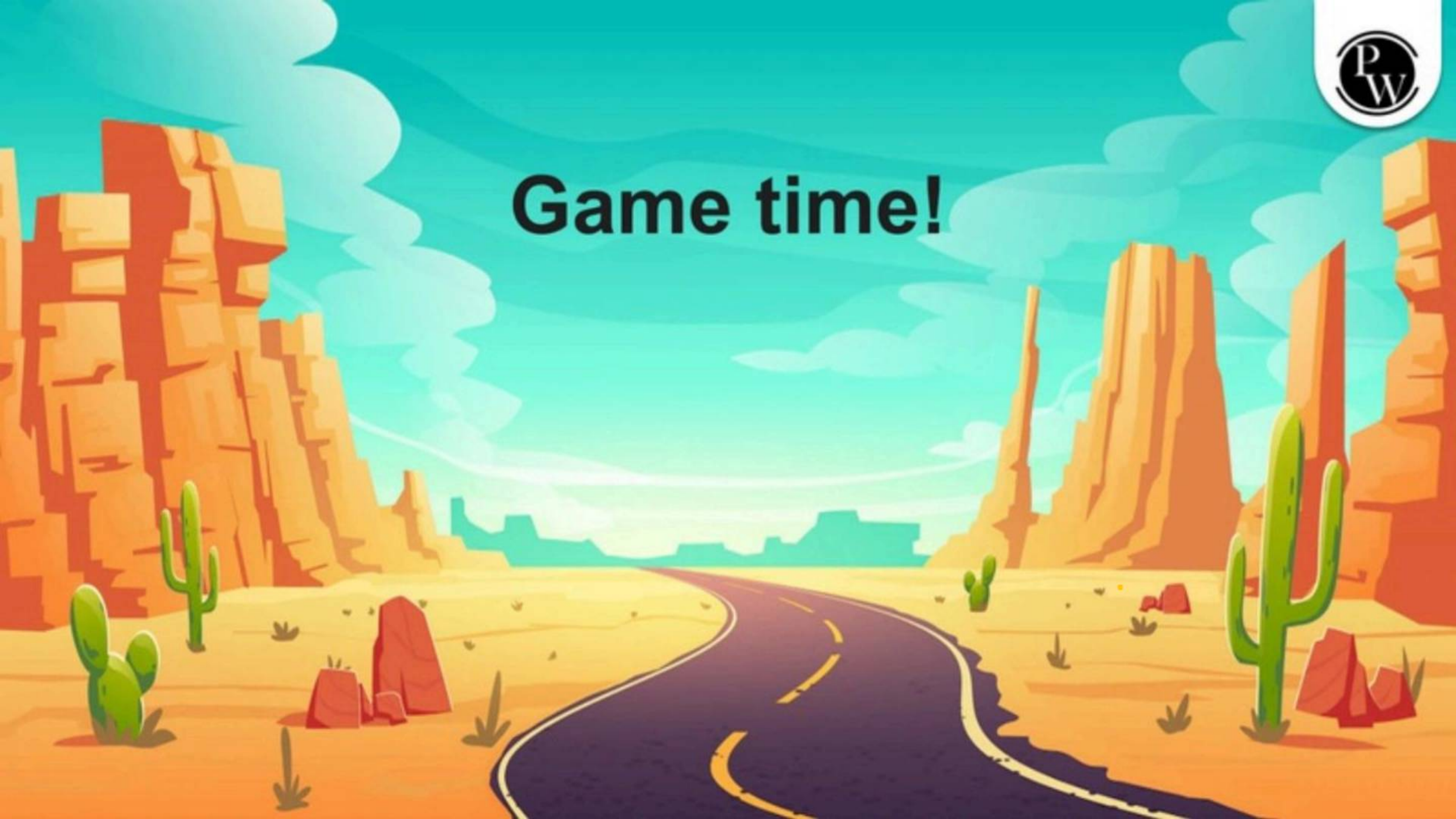


GAME TIME!





Game time!



Guess the words that have been combined to form the words below!



1



_____ + _____ = brunch

3



_____ + _____ = smog

5



network

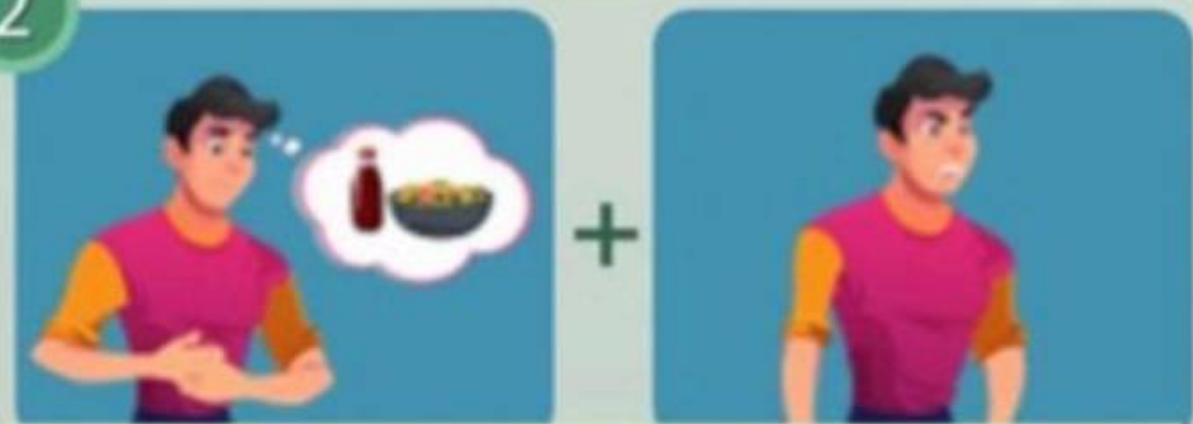
+

international



internet

2



_____ + _____ = hangry

4



_____ + _____ = vlog

Guess the words that have been combined to form the words below!



1



breakfast

+



lunch

brunch

a late morning meal eaten as a combination of breakfast and lunch

Portmanteau

3



smoke

+



fog

smog

a form of air pollution that is or looks like a mixture of smoke and fog

2



hungry

+

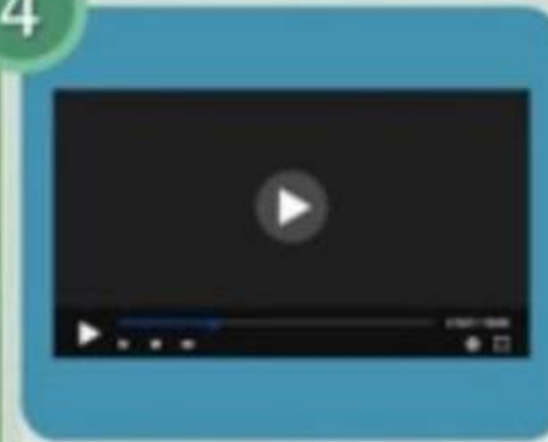


angry

hangry

angry or in a bad mood because you are hungry

4



video

+



blog

vlog

a blog in which the postings are in video form

Question 1



Select the option that can replace the given expression:

One who is new and inexperienced in a certain job -

A) Versatile

B) Veteran

C) Namesake

☒ D) Novice

Question 2

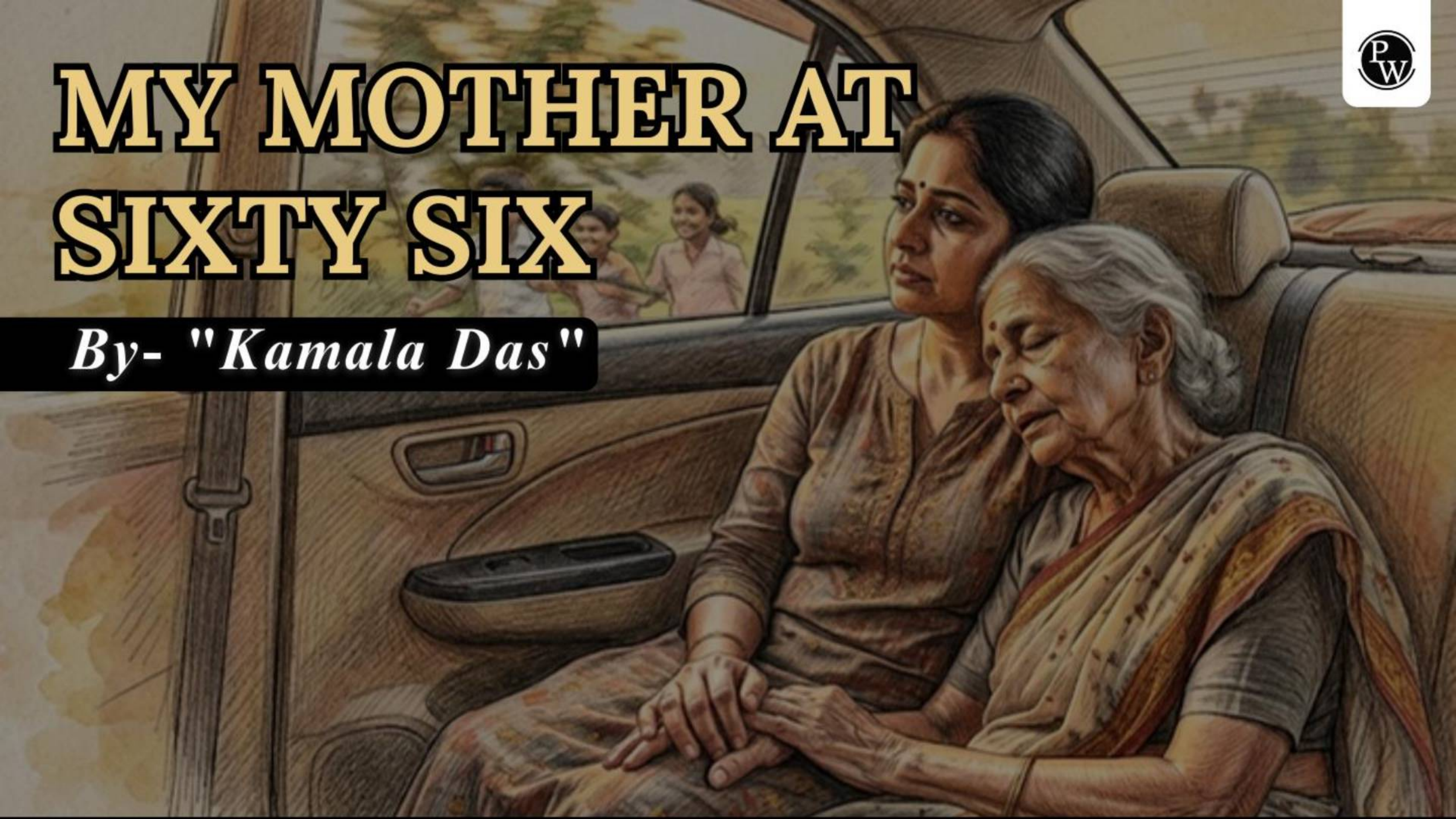


The new student felt like a fish out of water on the first day of school.

- A) Very comfortable
- ✓ B) Completely confused or uncomfortable
- C) Extremely happy
- D) Very confident

MY MOTHER AT SIXTY SIX

By- "Kamala Das"



Introduction



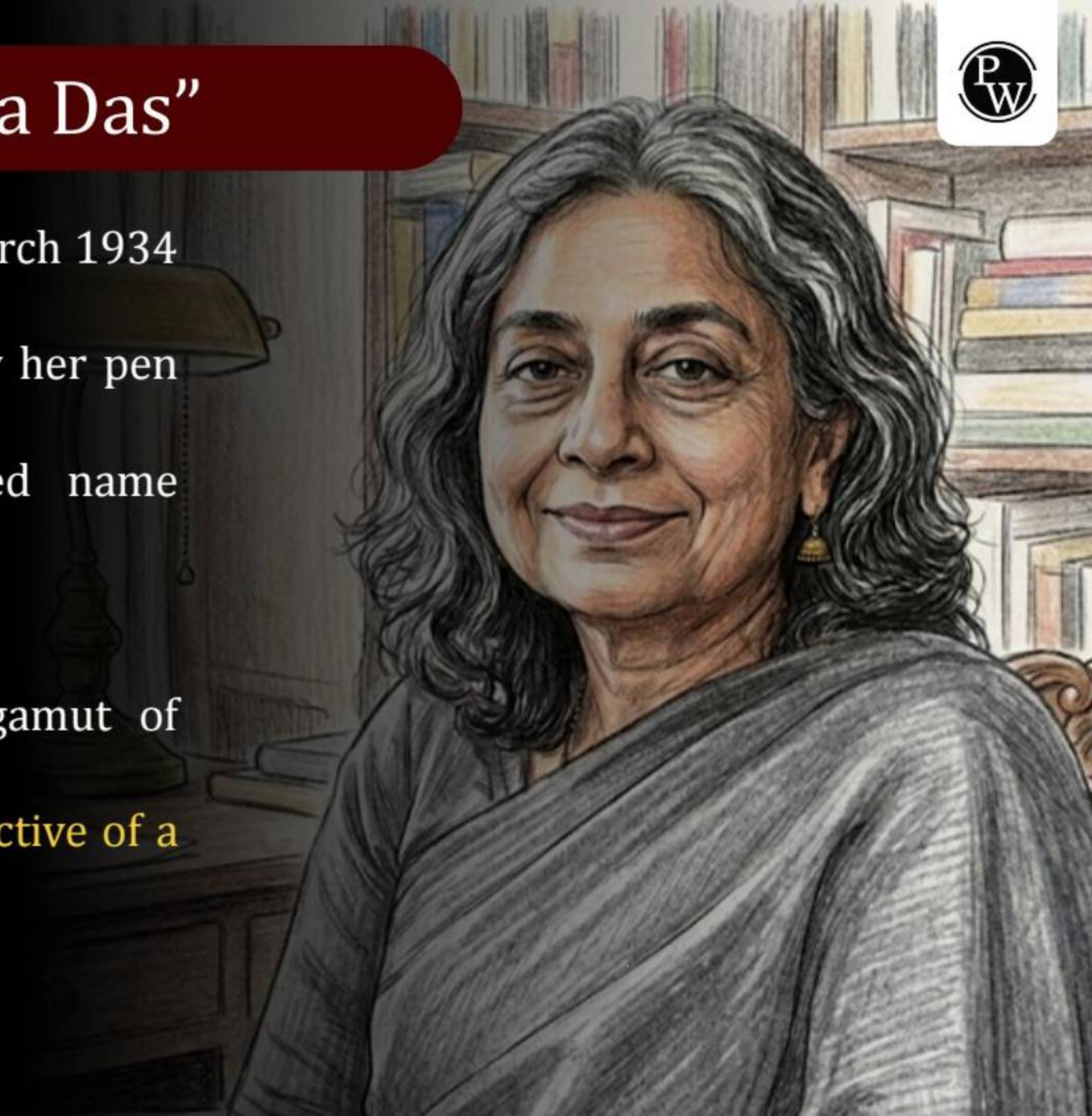
- The poet observes her mother's aging while traveling. She compares her mother's pale face to a corpse, reflecting on the fear of losing her.
- To escape sadness, she looks at children playing outside, symbolizing life.
- Despite her fears, she bids farewell with a smile.



About the Poet – “Kamala Das”



- Kamala Surayya (born Kamala; 31 March 1934 – 31 May 2009), popularly known by her pen name '**Madhavi Kutty**' and married name '**Kamala Das**'.
- Das's writing explores the entire gamut of **human relationships from the perspective of a woman.**



Driving from my parent's
home to Cochin last Friday
morning, I saw my mother,
next to
beside me,
Sleep lightly
doze, open mouthed, her face
lifeless, grey
ashen like that
of a corpse
dead body



and realized with

pain

that she was as old as she

looked but soon

diverted her attention
put that thought away, and

looked out at Young

running fastly *coming out in*
Trees sprinting, the merry children spilling

out of their homes, *happy* *large numbers*



but after the airport's

security check, standing a few yards

away, I looked again at her, wan, pale
dull
colourless

as a late winter's moon



and felt that old
Known pain fear of separation from
familiar ache, my childhood's fear, *mom*

but all I said was, see you soon, Amma,

all I did was smile and smile and smile..



Tone

- Nostalgic, melancholic

Theme

- Aging, mortality

Message

- Cherish loved ones as time is fleeting.



Topic : Message



Do not be so busy in the fulfillment of your desires that you forget to take care of your parents when they need you the most.

Glossary



- **Ducked into** : bent down to get in
- **Bumping** : meeting by chance
- **Glint** : a sudden flash of light
- **Snapped open** : opened quickly with a sudden sharp noise
- **Glanced** : looked quickly
- **Suburban trains** : city trains
- **Spittoons** : vessels for spitting into
- **Lapels** : a part of coat-front folded back

A scenic background image of a mountain landscape. In the foreground, there is a lush green field with several tall, dark evergreen trees. In the middle ground, a small white building with a dark roof is partially visible among more trees. The background features rolling green hills and distant, hazy mountain ranges under a clear blue sky.

POETIC DEVICES

Enjambement
Driving from my parent's

Imagery

home to Cochin last Friday morning,

I saw my mother, beside me,

doze, open mouthed, **her face**

ashen (like) that

Simile

of a corpse and realized with pain

that she was as old as she looked but soon

put that thought away, and

looked out at Young

Trees sprinting

Personification

the **merry children spilling**

out of their homes

Metaphor

but after the airport's

security check, standing a few yards

away, I looked again at her **wan, pale**

as a late winter's moon and felt that old

familiar ache, my childhood's fear,

but all I said was, see you soon, Amma,

all I did was **smile** and **smile** and

smile...

Repetition

Contrast

Simile

Topic: Poetic Devices



1. Simile

her face ashen like that
wan, pale as a late winter's moon

2. Metaphor

merry children spilling

3. Personification

Trees sprinting



Topic: Poetic Devices

4. Repetition

all I did was smile and smile and smile.....

5. Contrast

Inside the car

outside the car

Internal feelings of the poet at the end

Her facial expression (smile)

6. Imagery

Young trees sprinting

merry children spilling



Question 1



Choose the option that completes the sentence given below.

Just as the brightness of the winter's moon is veiled behind the haze and mist, similarly_____.

- A) the pain of separation has shaded mother's expression.**
- ☒ **B) age has fogged mother's youthful appearance.**
- C) growing up has developed a seasoned maturity in the poet.**
- D) memories warm the heart like the pale moon in winter.**

Question 2



What is the kind of pain and ache that the poet feels?

- A) Physical pain due to a long journey**
- B) Disappointment in her mother's behavior**
- C) Anxiety about the approaching flight**
- ✓ D) Fear of losing her aging mother**

Question 3



Why are the young trees described as 'sprinting'?

- A) The trees were being cut down rapidly
- B) The poet imagines them running for fun
- ☒ C) The motion of the car makes the trees appear to move
- D) A storm was making the trees sway wildly

Question 4



**Why has the poet brought in the image of the merry children
'spilling out of their homes'?**



- A) To show the chaos in the neighborhood
- ✓ B) To depict a contrast to her mother's aging and frailty
- C) To indicate school time in the morning
- D) To suggest that the children were chasing the poet's car

Question 5



Why has the mother been compared to the 'late winter's moon'?



- A) Because the moon is full and glowing like her face**
- B) To show the serenity and calmness in her expression**
- ✓ C) To indicate her old age, paleness, and fading vitality**
- D) Because her face looked round and bright like the moon**

Question 6



What do the parting words of the poet and her smile signify?

- ☒ **A) She is trying to comfort her mother and hide her sorrow**
- ☐ **B) She is angry but doesn't express it**
- ☐ **C) She is excited to be travelling alone**
- ☐ **D) She has nothing else to say at that moment**

Extract-Based Questions

H.W.



Read the extract and answer the questions that follow:

Driving from my parent's
home to Cochin last Friday
morning, I saw my mother,
beside me,
doze, open mouthed, her face
ashen like that
of a corpse and realised with
pain
that she was as old as she
looked but soon

put that thought away, and
looked out at **Young**
Trees sprinting, the merry children
spilling
out of their homes,
— **My Mother at Sixty-six**

Extract (ii)



Give the phrase that suggests the following:

The image of exuberance and youthfulness affects the poet's thoughts.

What does the imagery of “Trees sprinting” not represent?

A) energy ✗

B) liveliness ✗

✓ C) shade

D) vitality ✗

Extract (iv)



Fill in the blank:

The poet's use of the phrase **"ashen like that of a corpse"** illustrates the poet's use of imagery / Simile

Extract (iii)



Choose the correct option:

The poet is unable to bear the sight of her ageing mother because _____.

- A) her mother had refused to accompany her
- B) she is upset with her mother dozing off
- ✓ C) it upsets her to see the ageing face of her mother
- D) she is in a hurry to reach the airport

Extract (iii)



Assertion and Reason *True / False*

A: **Assertion:** The mother was accompanying her daughter to the airport.

B: **Reason:** The daughter was leaving her mother behind and flying off.

Choose the correct option regarding their relationship:

A) Both the assertion and the reason are true and the reason is the correct explanation of the assertion. *liveliness*

☒ B) Both the assertion and the reason are true, but the reason is not the correct explanation of the assertion.

C) The assertion is true, but the reason is false. *α*

D) The assertion is false, but the reason is true. *α*

①
② because

Topic: Summary



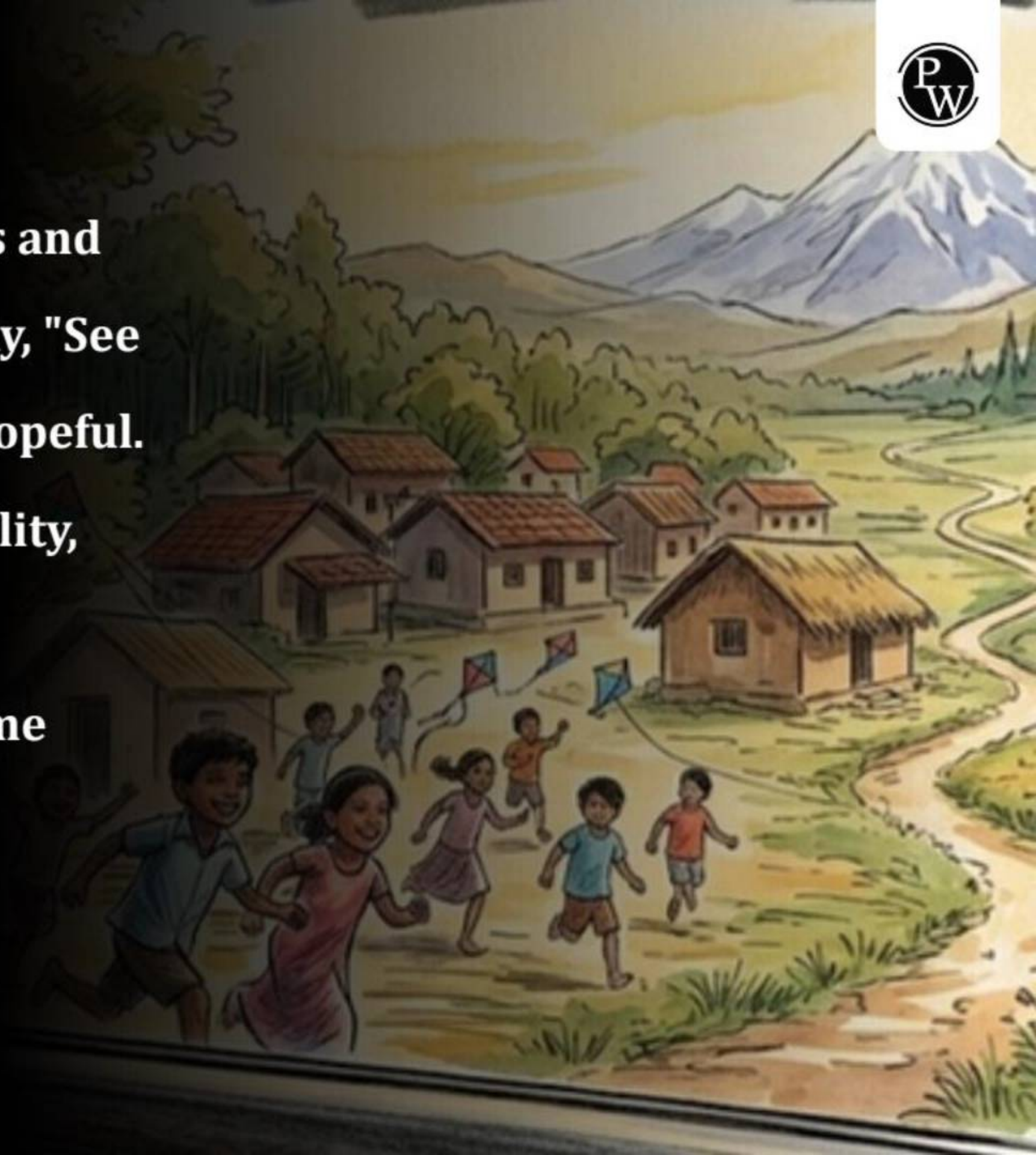
- **Setting & Context:** The speaker is driving to Cochin airport on a Friday morning, with her mother seated beside her.
- **Mother's Appearance:** She notices her mother sleeping, with her mouth open, looking pale, ashen, and corpse-like.
- **Realization of Mortality:** The sight makes the speaker painfully aware of her mother's aging and imminent mortality.



- **Distraction:** To divert her thoughts, she looks out the car window and observes the lively world outside—young trees sprinting past and children rushing out of their homes.
- **Airport Scene:** At the airport, after the security check, she looks at her mother again, who appears pale and frail, like a "late winter's moon".
- **Childhood Fear:** The image rekindles her childhood fears of separation and loss.



- **Hiding Emotions:** She masks her sadness and fear, choosing to smile repeatedly and say, "See you soon, Amma," to keep the moment hopeful.
- **Theme:** The poem explores aging, mortality, separation, and the inevitability of loss, highlighting the painful realization of time slipping away.



Difficult Expressions, Meanings and Symbolism

“doze, open-mouthed”

- **Meaning:** The poet's mother is dozing with her mouth open, showing signs of old age and weakness.
- **Symbolism:** Represents physical decline and helplessness.

“ashen like that of a corpse”

- **Meaning:** The face of the poet's mother is pale and lifeless like that of a dead body.
- **Symbolism:** Represents aging and the inevitability of death.

“childhood's fear”

- **Meaning:** The poet's long-standing fear of separation from her mother.
- **Symbolism:** Represents the universal fear of losing loved ones.

Topic: Question



✓ Why does Kamala Das compare to her mother to 'a late winter's moon'?

Delhi 2017

Or

✓ Why has the poet's mother been compared to the 'late winter's moon'?

Delhi 2013

Or

✓ Why has Kamala Das compared her mother to a 'late winter's moon'?

Foreign 2011

Topic: Question



✓ **What was Kamala Das's childhood fear?**

All India 2017

Or

What childhood fear did Kamala Das refer to in her poem? How did she hide it?

Delhi 2015

Or

What was the poet's childhood fear?

All India 2014

Or

What were Kamala Das, fears as a child? Why do they surface when she is going to the airport?

All India 2011

Topic: Question



✓ **Why does the poetess look at 'young trees' and 'merry children'?**

CBSE 2018 SQP

Or

Having looked at her mother, why does Kamala Das look at the young children?

All India 2017

Topic: Question



Why does the poetess look at 'young trees' and 'merry children'?

CBSE 2018 SQP

Or

Having looked at her mother, why does Kamala Das look at the young children?

All India 2017

Ans . Kamala Das looked at the young children as they represented youth, which is full of life and energy. She wanted to drive away the fearful and disturbing thought that her mother was getting old and weak and might die soon.

Topic: Question



✓ **Why does Kamala Das compare to her mother to 'a late winter's moon'?** ☆ ☆

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Why has Kamala Das compared her mother to a 'late winter's moon'?

Foreign 2011

Ans. The poet's mother has been compared to the 'late winter's moon' as the late winter's moon is dull, shrouded symbolising the end of life. Similarly, the poet's mother is pale and old indicating that she is nearing the end of her life.

Topic: Question



What was Kamala Das's childhood fear?

All India 2017

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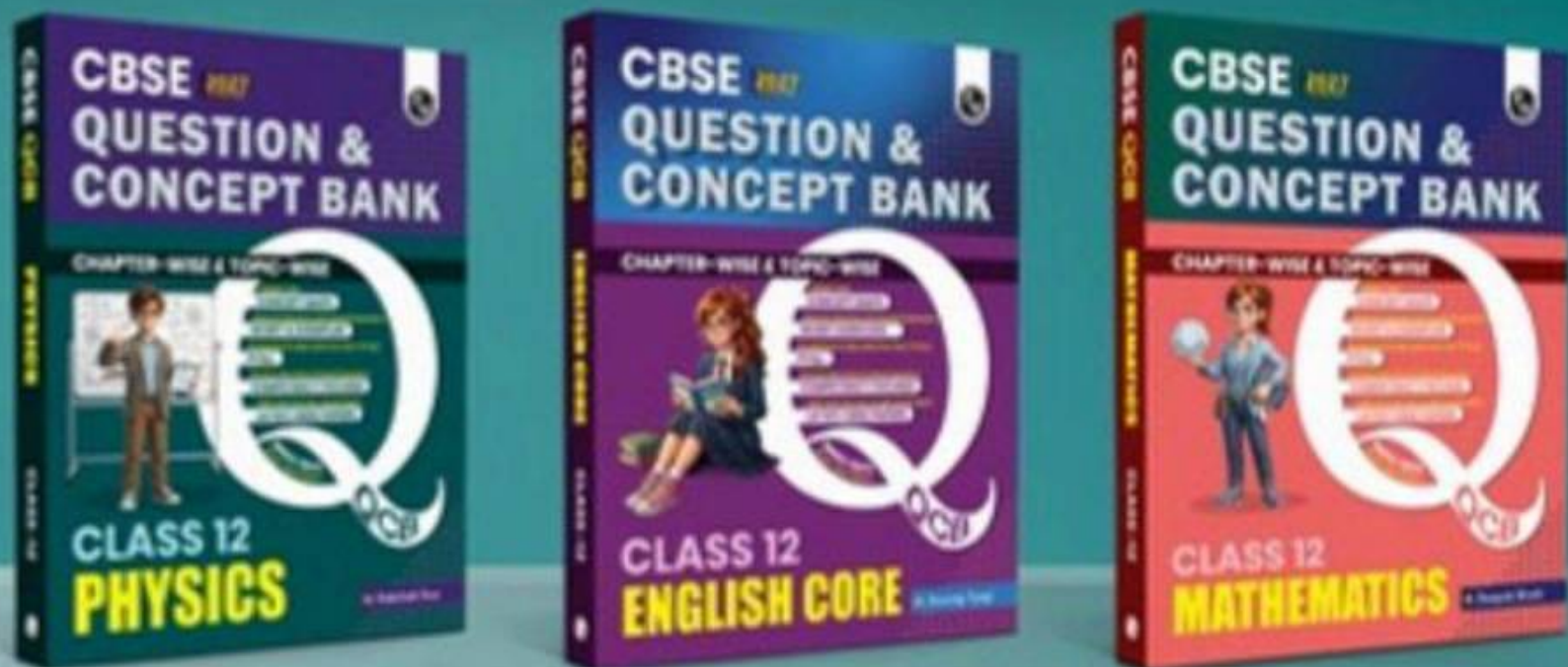
Topic: Answer



Ans. As a child, Kamala Das was insecure about losing her mother just as all young children usually are. The same feelings are evoked in her while she is on the way to the airport as she sees her mother's pale face, which is a sign of her old age and impending death. She attempts to hide this fear through her long and superficial smile.

WHERE QUESTIONS LEAD YOUR PREPARATION FOLLOWS

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Thank
you